

Snakefolk Bloodlines

Snakefolk Bloodlines is a monster supplement for 5e that explores serpent-kin as multiple evolutionary bloodlines rather than a single unified species. Instead of presenting snakefolk as a generic cultist race or singular jungle civilization, this book divides them into distinct biological doctrines shaped by the hunting methods of real-world serpents.

Each lineage represents a different philosophy of survival. Cobra bloodlines rule through intimidation and venomous ritual authority. Rattlers dominate harsh deserts through warning, ambush, and coordinated aggression. Boas rely on overwhelming physical strength and constricting brutality. Vipers evolve toward stealth, assassination, and surgical lethality. Sea snakes claim coastal waters and submerged domains through speed and aquatic dominance.

The goal of this product is encounter variety through evolutionary design rather than simple CR escalation. Each ladder progresses from lesser members of a bloodline to powerful apex figures that command territory, cults, or hunting packs. These snakefolk are not mindless monsters; they are calculating predators whose tactics mirror the instincts of their ancestral species.

Cultural lore is intentionally minimal. Whether these bloodlines are ancient offshoots of a shared serpent empire, competing evolutionary branches, or separate creations of forgotten gods is left to the GM. The stat blocks in this book are tools for building encounters shaped by instinct, environment, and predatory doctrine.

The Naga (Cobra Bloodline)

The Naga represent the regal and priestly lineage of snakefolk society. Inspired by the iconic cobra, these serpent rulers rely on intimidation, ritual authority, and venom magic to control territory and followers.

Naga encounters emphasize dominance and mysticism. Their expanded hoods, venom rituals, and commanding presence make them natural leaders among serpent-kind. They rarely fight alone, preferring to command lesser snakefolk or cultists while striking with precise venomous power when challenged directly.

A Naga force feels ceremonial and controlled, with authority rooted in ancient serpent traditions and venom-infused magic.

The Rattlers

Rattler snakefolk evolved for harsh desert survival. Their segmented tail rattles serve as both warning and weapon, announcing their presence before battle erupts into violent ambush.

Rattler encounters emphasize intimidation, coordinated aggression, and sudden explosive attacks. Their rattles echo across desert canyons and dry valleys, signaling territorial dominance and rallying nearby warriors.

A Rattler force feels brutal and territorial. They fight like a desert storm—sudden, loud, and overwhelming.

The Boas

Boa bloodlines represent the raw physical power of snakefolk evolution. These massive constrictors dominate through strength, crushing coils, and unstoppable endurance.

Boa encounters emphasize grappling, battlefield control, and brute force. Rather than relying on venom or magic, they overpower enemies with overwhelming strength and relentless pressure.

A Boa force feels slow but inevitable. Once their coils tighten around a battlefield, escape becomes nearly impossible.

The Vipers

Viper snakefolk are the assassins of serpent-kind. Sleek, fast, and lethally precise, they specialize in stealth, ambush, and targeted elimination of key enemies.

Viper encounters emphasize agility, poison, and surgical violence. They prefer shadows, narrow spaces, and nighttime assaults where their speed and venom give them overwhelming advantage.

A Viper force feels like a silent knife in the dark—appearing suddenly, striking with lethal precision, and disappearing before retaliation.

The Sea Snakes

Sea Snake bloodlines adapted fully to coastal and ocean environments. Their sleek aquatic bodies allow them to dominate reefs, shorelines, and submerged ruins.

Sea Snake encounters emphasize mobility, water control, and lightning-fast aquatic combat. They strike from beneath the waves, dragging enemies into dangerous waters where they hold every advantage.

A Sea Snake force feels fluid and relentless, turning oceans and coastlines into deadly hunting grounds.

NAGA (COBRA BLOODLINE) ROSTER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Naga Acolyte	1	Young cobra-blood serpent priest learning venom rituals and temple authority.
Naga Hoodwarden	3	Disciplined temple guardian enforcing naga rule with intimidation and venom strikes.
Naga Venom Priest	6	Serpent spellcaster wielding toxic magic and ritual venom to dominate the battlefield.
Naga Coil Sovereign	9	Supreme cobra ruler commanding serpent temples and enforcing naga dominion.

RATTLER ROSTER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Rattler Scout	1/2	Desert patrol hunter stalking prey using stealth and its warning rattle.
Rattler Sandstalker	2	Ambush predator specialized in sudden desert attacks and rapid strikes.
Rattler Dreadshaker	5	Terrifying war leader whose vibrating rattle signals battle and shakes enemy morale.
Rattler War-Caller	8	Battlefield commander rallying rattler tribes through thunderous rattle signals.

BOA ROSTER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Boa Coilguard	1	Powerful serpent warrior using constricting coils to capture and restrain enemies.
Boa Bonecrusher	4	Brutal constrictor crushing opponents with overwhelming strength.
Boa Ironcoil	7	Veteran serpent champion whose immense coils dominate the battlefield.
Boa Titan	10	Colossal constrictor capable of shattering armor and bone through sheer strength.

VIPER ROSTER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Viper Initiate	1	Young assassin trained in stealth and venom-coated blades.
Viper Shadowfang	3	Elite stealth killer striking swiftly from darkness.
Viper Bloodletter	6	Lethal battlefield assassin specializing in rapid poison strikes.
Viper Deathseer	9	Legendary serpent assassin whose venom and speed make escape nearly impossible.

SEA SNAKE ROSTER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Sea Snake Tidekin	1	Aquatic hunter patrolling reefs and coastal waters.
Sea Snake Reef Hunter	3	Swift underwater predator specializing in spear combat.
Sea Snake Stormcoil	6	Sea warrior channeling storm energy and lightning strikes.
Sea Snake Abyssal Regent	9	Powerful ocean ruler commanding coastal serpent domains.

NAGA VENOM PRIEST

Medium humanoid (snakefolk), lawful evil

Armor Class 15 (ritual scales)

Hit Points 112 (15d8 + 45)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	18 (+4)	17 (+3)

Saving Throws Wis +7, Con +6

Skills Religion +5, Insight +7, Deception +6

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 14

Languages Common, Serpent Tongue

Challenge 6 (2,300 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +3

Serpent Authority. Allied snakefolk within 30 feet of this naga have advantage on saving throws against being frightened.

Venom Mastery. Creatures poisoned by this naga have disadvantage on their first saving throw made each turn against one of its abilities.

Innate Spellcasting. This naga's spellcasting ability is Wisdom (spell save DC 15, +7 to hit with spell attacks). It can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material components:

- **At will:** *poison spray*
- **3/day each:** *ray of sickness*, *hold person*
- **1/day each:** *stinking cloud*

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The naga makes two attacks with its ritual staff.

Ritual Staff. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d8 + 3) bludgeoning damage plus 9 (2d8) poison damage.

Venomous Invocation (Recharge 5–6). Each enemy within 20 feet of this naga must make a DC 15 Constitution saving throw, taking 27 (6d8) poison damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one.

- Venom Priests lead temple rituals and command lower snakefolk in battle.
- It begins combat with control spells like *hold person* before using Venomous Invocation.
- The priest stays behind stronger allies while using magic and venom to weaken enemies.



VIPERS

VIPER INITIATE

Medium humanoid (snakefolk), chaotic evil

Armor Class 14 (light scales)

Hit Points 32 (5d8 + 10)

Speed 35 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
11 (+0)	17 (+3)	14 (+2)	11 (+0)	13 (+1)	11 (+0)

Skills Stealth +5, Acrobatics +5, Perception +3

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 13

Languages Common, Serpent Tongue

Challenge 1 (200 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Sudden Strike. This viper initiate has advantage on attack rolls against creatures that have not yet taken a turn in combat.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. This viper initiate makes two attacks with its fang dagger.

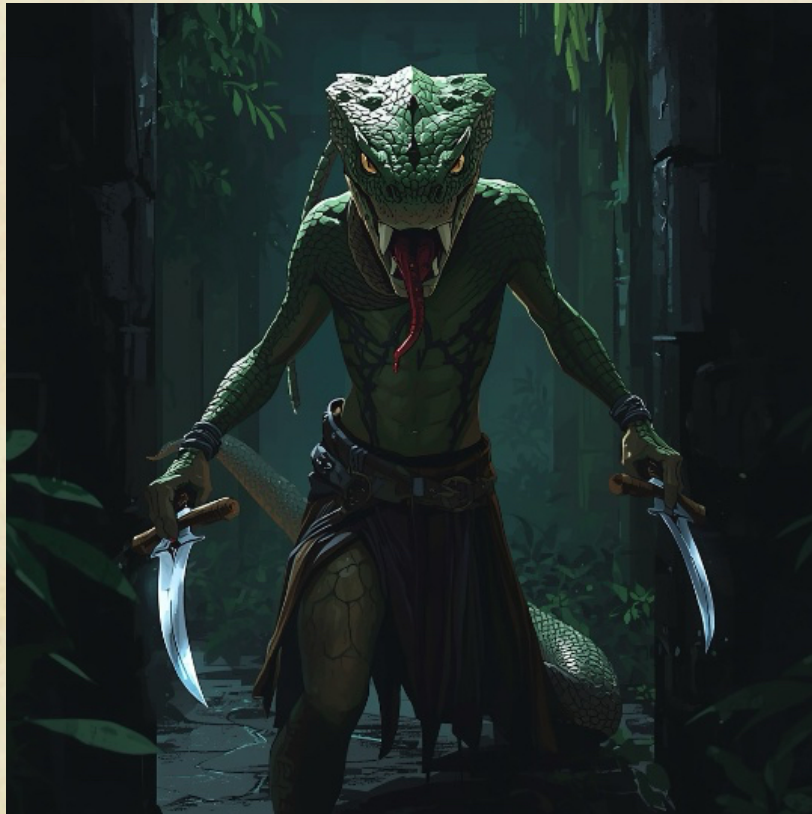
Fang Dagger. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 3) piercing damage plus 4 (1d8) poison damage.

Toxic Jab (Recharge 5–6). This viper initiate makes one Fang Dagger attack. If the attack hits, the target must succeed on a DC 12 Constitution saving throw or be poisoned until the end of its next turn.

REACTIONS

Serpent Reflex. When a creature misses this viper initiate with a melee attack, this viper initiate can move up to 10 feet without provoking opportunity attacks.

- Viper Initiates are fast assassins that rely on speed and venom rather than strength.
- It attempts to strike early in combat using Sudden Strike for advantage.
- If pressured, it uses Serpent Reflex to reposition and attack from another angle.



SEA SNAKE ABYSSAL REGENT

Medium humanoid (snakefolk), neutral evil

Armor Class 17 (abyssal scales)

Hit Points 168 (16d8 + 96)

Speed 30 ft., swim 60 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	18 (+4)	20 (+5)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	18 (+4)

Saving Throws Dex +8, Con +9, Wis +7, Cha +8

Skills Athletics +7, Perception +7, Intimidation +8

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 17

Languages Common, Serpent Tongue

Challenge 9 (5,000 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +4

Amphibious. This regent can breathe both air and water.

Tide Command. Allied snakefolk within 30 feet of this regent gain a swim speed equal to their walking speed and advantage on the first attack roll they make each round while in water.

Depth Predator. This regent has advantage on attack rolls against creatures that are swimming.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. This regent makes three attacks with its abyss spear.

Abyss Spear. *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d8 + 4) piercing damage plus 10 (3d6) poison damage.

Crushing Current (Recharge 5–6). Each creature within 20 feet must succeed on a DC 16 Strength saving throw or take 27 (6d8) bludgeoning damage and be knocked prone. On a success, a creature takes half damage and isn't knocked prone.

REACTIONS

Slip Into Depth. When this regent takes damage while in water, it can move up to its swim speed without provoking opportunity attacks.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

This regent can take 2 legendary actions, choosing from the options below. Only one legendary action option can be used at a time and only at the end of another creature's turn. This regent regains spent legendary actions at the start of its turn.

Spear Strike (1 Action). This regent makes one Abyss Spear attack.

Tidal Shift (1 Action). This regent moves up to half its swim speed.

- Abyssal Regents rule coastal temples and underwater cities.
- It prefers to fight in water where Tide Command empowers its allies.
- The regent constantly repositions using Slip Into Depth to control the battlefield.



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